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REGION

STATEMENT ON THE uMKHANYAKUDE WATER TANKER PROCUREMENT

26 AUGUST 2026

The African National Congress (ANC) Nokuhamba Nyawo Region notes with concern the recent public comments by the KwaZulu-Natal MEC for Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs, MEC Thulasizwe Buthelezi, regarding uMkhanyakude District Municipality's decision to procure five water tankers.

The people of uMkhanyakude deserve a water solution that is sustainable, affordable, and capable of responding to their daily realities. The current debate over the procurement of water tankers must therefore move beyond political exchanges and focus squarely on the interests of ordinary residents. The people of uMkhanyakude cannot be expected to plan their lives around whether a tanker will arrive tomorrow. Children need water at schools, elderly residents need water in their homes, businesses need water to operate, and rural households need reliable access to water to maintain their dignity.

Water is a necessity, not political football. For the people of uMkhanyakude, the water crisis is not a matter that exists only in council meetings or government statements, but it is experienced every day. There is nothing inherently reckless about a municipality acquiring assets that are necessary to fulfil its service-delivery responsibilities. If a municipality repeatedly hires water tankers whenever communities experience shortages, it remains dependent on recurring rental expenditure. When a municipality purchases its own tankers, those vehicles become municipal assets that can potentially serve communities for years.

uMkhanyakude deserves better than political point-scoring. The African National Congress Nokuhamba Nyawo Region rejects an approach in which the suffering of communities becomes an opportunity for political point-scoring. Our people need water in their homes, schools, clinics, and communities. We also

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question the wisdom of publicly attacking a municipal decision before establishing all the facts. There is nothing wrong with provincial government exercising oversight, but oversight must be constructive. The first step should be engagement with the municipality to understand the financial assessment that informed the procurement decision and to identify whether there are genuine risks that require intervention.

The ANC Nokuhamba Nyawo Region will continue to stand firmly for the interests of the people of uMkhanyakude and will support interventions that expand sustainable access to water while demanding accountability from every sphere of government entrusted with public resources.

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